AIIMS Patna Sarthi — Concept Note

A patient navigation and OPD companion app, with a Phase 2 sample-tracking consumable

Digital Health & AI in Healthcare | Working prototype (sample data only) | 24 October 2026

The problem

A patient arriving at AIIMS Patna for the first time has to find the right department, work out the registration and token system, locate the right lab counter for each test, and then come back for the report. Most of this information is passed on verbally, so patients and their attendants lose hours, ask repeatedly at counters, and often miss their turn. The same load falls on hospital staff, who answer the same directions questions all day instead of attending to clinical work.

The solution — two phases

Phase 1 — the app (already built and live)

- OPD token and live queue — token number, people ahead, estimated wait
- Department navigation — floor plan, QR points and GPS, turn-by-turn
- Tests and lab token, reports, payment and receipt
- Emergency — one-tap call to 108
- Appointments, follow-up, family sharing
- 4 languages, accessible (large text, dark mode, voice), works offline
- 136 screens, currently live at the link below

Phase 2 — QR sample kit (the biotech component)

- Every specimen collection vial carries a printed QR label
- Scanning at collection links the sample to the patient's token
- The app shows live status: collected → lab → in queue → report ready
- Reduces sample loss and "where is my report" counter visits
- The consumable to be manufactured through a licensed partner

Market

- **Beachhead:** AIIMS Patna OPD — a large, high-footfall government tertiary hospital with a first-time-visitor-heavy patient mix.
- **Next:** other government medical colleges and district hospitals in Bihar, then other states.
- **Who pays:** the institution (licence / per-department subscription), not the patient. The app stays free for patients.

Team

Abhinav Kumar — product and development. Clinical and regulatory guidance sought through APIIC and AIIMS Patna departments. (Additional team members to be added before the pilot.)

Regulatory position — stated plainly

What the app is not: it is a navigation and workflow tool. It does not diagnose, prescribe, monitor or predict any disease. The AI features give general health information only and say so on every answer. The app is not a medical device and we make no diagnostic claim.

Phase 2: a specimen collection consumable. Its risk class and licence route will be confirmed in writing by CDSCO before any manufacture, labelling or sale. No performance claim will be printed without validated data.

The ask

- **Incubation** at APIIC, and an incubation **Letter of Intent** (required for BIRAC BIG).
- **Funding guidance** — APIIC Ignition Grant, DST-NIDHI, BIRAC eYUVA / BIG, Bihar Startup Policy.
- **A pilot** in one AIIMS Patna OPD department, at no cost to the hospital.
- **Written regulatory guidance** on the Phase 2 consumable's classification.

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